

Fraud Alert Investigation Playbook (Reference)

Sample reference document • For FraudPilot agent grounding/evaluation • Fictional environment for demo purposes

1. Card-Testing / Bot Attack

Recognize it by: many small transactions across different merchants within minutes, from a new device, often several declines followed by one approval.

Typical path: check account activity/velocity first, then device/session info to confirm a new, unfamiliar device.

2. Account Takeover (ATO)

Recognize it by: a new device and an IP geolocation far from the customer's home region, often shortly after a password or contact-info change, followed by an unusually large transaction.

Typical path: check device/session info, then account activity for the size of the transaction relative to baseline, then recent alerts for prior warning signs.

3. Legitimate Travel Purchase (False Positive)

Recognize it by: a large or foreign purchase that otherwise looks unusual, but the customer risk profile shows a matching travel notice or booking on file.

Typical path: check the transaction location, then the customer risk profile for a travel notice, before concluding fraud.

4. Synthetic Identity / First-Party Fraud

Recognize it by: a new account with thin history, rapid credit-limit utilization, and mismatched KYC details, with no genuine prior spending pattern.

Typical path: check the customer risk profile and account tenure first, then account activity for a lack of an established baseline.

5. Merchant-Side Compromise

Recognize it by: a cluster of otherwise-unrelated customers reporting fraud at the same merchant shortly after a suspected breach.

Typical path: check merchant risk data for a recent fraud-report spike, then recent alerts across other accounts for the same merchant pattern.

6. Diagnostic Tool Quick Reference

Use this table to decide which tool to call first based on the strongest available signal. Every recommendation remains advisory only; a human analyst makes the final call.

Tool	When to Use	Key Signal
get_transaction_details	Any alert on a specific transaction	amount, merchant, channel, location
get_account_activity	Judging whether a transaction is unusual	deviation from spending baseline
get_device_session_info	Suspected ATO or bot activity	new device, VPN, distance from home
get_customer_risk_profile	Need travel notice or KYC/watchlist context	risk tier, tenure, prior fraud flags
get_merchant_risk_data	Suspected merchant-side compromise	chargeback rate, recent fraud reports
get_recent_alerts	Establishing account investigation history	prior alerts and confirmed outcomes